

“Ambiverts are socially bilingual. This flexibility is priceless in today’s volatile environment. Externally, ambiverts know how to show up with investors, media, and other stakeholders, as their public face shows clarity and conviction. Internally, they allow themselves to slow down, listen deeply, and create psychological safety for their teams.” This balance, she says, builds trust, an asset that drives sustainable performance. “Ambivert leadership isn’t about changing who you are, it’s about expanding how you show up,” she says.

LEADING IN A HYBRID WORKPLACE

Hybrid work has rewritten the play-book for leadership. Parashar says

brid work demands that leaders constantly shift gears, solitary work the one moment, high-energy collaboration the next,” she says. Connection is another hurdle. “Extroverted leaders may dominate in-person meetings and overlook remote voices while introverted leaders struggle to energise hybrid discussions. Decision-making too feels harder, top-down certainty no longer works when no one has all the answers. Leaders have to balance deep listening with decisive action, which can stretch both introverts and extroverts.” For Parashar, ambiversion, the ability to flex between reflection and action, visibility and listening, is key to sustaining energy for both leaders and teams. In hybrid world,

CONVICTION OVER CHARISMA

For emerging leaders who fear that a softer voice might hold them back, the advice is clear: conviction matters more than volume. Shivakumar acknowledges that a quieter style can be a challenge “in a loud company, in a company that values bravado over reflection” but stresses that results, and how they are delivered, define success. “One of the things a quieter leader should use strategically is silence. When a leader is silent on an issue, it makes people nervous,” he says. Shivakumar also recommends asking insightful questions of boisterous colleagues and “outsourcing some of the extroverted aspects” by empowering team members to play

MATURE BUSINESSES, LARGER CONGLOMERATES OFTEN VEER TOWARDS AMBIVERT TRAITS, WHEREAS START-UPS AND NEW-AGE COMPANIES MAY LEAN TOWARDS EXTROVERTED LEADERSHIP

leaders today operate in “a far more complex world post-Covid” where expectations have shifted dramatically. “They are making decisions around flexible workplaces, inter-generational teams, and now the assimilation of AI. The structure of the workplace, the composition of the workforce, and even what work looks like have changed fundamentally,” she says. Leading teams that mix generations, cultures, employment models, and even machines and bots is, “challenging to say the least,” she says.

Parashar highlights “managing energy” as the biggest test. “Hy-

brid leadership is less about volume and more about range, she says

The traits organisations prize are shifting as well. Shivakumar says work-from-home and hybrid models have eroded traditional workplace relationships.

“Teamwork has become more difficult. A lot of meetings happen online, and online, you cannot be a quiet leader, as people expect you to speak and show energy,” he says. In his view, virtual settings favour extroverts over quieter leaders. Even celebrations require rethinking when employees are dispersed across physical and digital spaces.

devil’s advocate, ensuring robust debate without forcing the leader to dominate the room.

Nayar has advice for young leaders: “Stop benchmarking yourself against personality. Visibility should amplify belief, not substitute for it,” he says. For him, listening deeply, reflecting honestly, and acting consistently create far more following than any display of charisma. “If you have a strong conviction and can articulate it clearly and convincingly, it adds steroids to the transformation you are attempting. But what you believe in will always come first.” **BT**